STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			AU-4300
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **Greg London** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 10/10/07	DATE REVISED **03/07/23**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE AUXILIARY UNITS: CRISIS NEGOTIATIONS UNIT	RESOURCES			
SUBJECT CNU OPERATIONS AND TRAINING	CROSS REFERENCE			

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish guidelines for the Sarpy County Crisis Negotiations Unit operations during deployments and training.

II. Policy:

The Sarpy County Crisis Negotiations Unit (CNU) comprised of trained negotiators from the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office, La Vista PD, and Papillion PD is designed to act in conjunction with other Law Enforcement personnel and specialty units within Sarpy County during high risk and emergency situations. The CNU shall function under all policies and procedures established for the Sarpy County CNU including all appropriate use of force policies. The operations of the CNU, including training, shall be controlled by policy and procedure and closely supervised by the CNU Commander.

III. Procedure:

A. Training: Deputies/officers assigned to the CNU shall receive initial Negotiation Level I training which includes:

1. A minimum of 40 hours in a qualified course

2. Training should include basic concepts and techniques, abnormal psychology, assessment, crisis/suicide intervention, active listening skills, case studied, meaningful role-playing drills, and an incident management overview

3. If practical and available, attending additional Levels of training is recommended

B. **On-Going Training:** As with all critical Law Enforcement skills, Negotiators shall receive updated training and practice in order to maintain proficiency. Negotiators shall annually attend 40 hours of training to maintain this proficiency.

1. The training program shall be developed by CNU members with the approval of the CNU Commander.

2. The CNU Commander shall schedule periodic training for all negotiators both in conjunction with and separate from the Sarpy County SWAT.

3. All CNU members are required to attend training. If a member is unable to attend training, the CNU Commander must be notified prior to the training date and provided the reason the member will be unable to attend training.

4. Members of the CNU who receive "Specialty Pay", as governed by the F.O.P. Lodge #3 Sworn Contract (Article 21, Section 5) for being Crisis Negotiators along with members from La Vista PD, and Papillion PD shall be present at 75% of training for a continuous one (1) calendar year period.

a) A missed training for a previously scheduled absence from work in which the CNU Member has notified the CNU Commander will not count against the CNU Member.

b) If a CNU Member has a more than 25% unexcused absence rate from training, their CNU Team Leader will notify the CNU Commander.

c) The CNU Commander and CNU Team Leaders will meet to determine the appropriate course of action. The CNU Commander and CNU Team Leader may elect to initiate remedial training or submit a memorandum to the Sheriff or Chiefs to remove the CNU Member from the Crisis Negotiations Unit.

d) Internal Affairs Investigations and disciplinary action arising out of a Team member's conduct, omissions, actions, etc. while serving on the Team shall be handled by Team member's Agency. Notification or initiation of an investigation will follow the employing Agency's policies. A member may be suspended from the CNU Team until such investigation has concluded.

5. Members of CNU may be removed from the Unit for cause based on the recommendation of the CNU Commander for any of the following reasons:

a) Failure to meet minimum/ongoing training standards
b) Poor performance
c) Poor training attendance
d) Poor call-out attendance

e) Professional Misconduct
f) Violation of policy

6. The CNU Commander or his/her designee shall document each training exercise with a synopsis of the training presented and a list of all attending members. The documentation shall be maintained by the CNU Commander or his/her designee and shall be forwarded to the Executive Board as well as each Departments Training Unit.

7. As part of CNU training, all personal and unit equipment shall be inspected and inventoried. This inspection shall occur at least quarterly. The CNU Commander or designee shall maintain a unit equipment inventory.

C. **Uniform for CNU Training:** each member shall be dressed in the required authorized uniform for CNU during all training, with the exception of members that are currently on duty attending training. Those members, on duty, may be dressed in that day's duty uniform.

D. **Operations:** During deployments, the CNU Commander shall oversee and direct the unit.

1. Any time the CNU is deployed, the Sheriff, Chief Deputy and ADC shall be notified by the CNU Commander/Supervisor.

2. When deployed for an incident, at least one CNU member shall respond to the necessary location to gather all Unit equipment.

3. At a minimum three (3) Negotiators shall be present for all negotiations

4. CNU Team members will assemble at the staging area and be formally briefed on the situation by the Commander or Team Leader

5. The Commander or Team Leader will select a location and set up the Negotiations Van

6. Intelligence gathering will begin immediately

a) Verify complaint/interview complainant
b) Interview first responders
c) Run history on the location
d) Canvas the area for witnesses
e) Run all vehicle registrations in the immediate area

7. The Commander or Team Leader will notify the High Risk Incident Commander when CNU is operation ready:

A CNU member, at the direction of the CNU Commander, shall make contact with the subject(s) at the scene after containment is established and confirmed. Generally, contact shall not be delayed to gather a full team or equipment. A negotiation team shall be established when sufficient personnel and equipment have arrived on location. The team shall consist of:

a) A primary negotiator.
b) A secondary negotiator.
c) An electronics/intelligence deputy.
d) A Psychologist, If able, to respond to the incident

8. Additional responding CNU members shall be assigned tasks by the CNU Commander or Team Leader when a command post has been established.

9. Generally, the CNU shall be responsible for establishing and maintaining an open line of communication with subjects to assess demands and attempt to resolve or defuse a high risk incident with minimal use of force and minimal risk of injury to all involved parties.

10. Negotiators should not become physically involved in a tactical situation.

11. Demands of subjects shall be negotiable; however, supplying weapons or providing or exchanging hostages shall be prohibited.

12. The CNU Commander shall be responsible for monitoring the situation and providing the High Risk Incident Commander with current information regarding the negotiations process and the viability of a resolution stemming from negotiations.

13. Only sworn personnel shall conduct negotiations unless authorized by the CNU Commander and the High Risk Incident Commander.

14. The CNU Commander shall have the authority, upon consultation with the High Risk Incident Commander, to request Omaha Police Emergency

Response Unit negotiators be activated to respond to any incident in place of or to relieve the CNU. The CNU Commander shall notify the Sheriff and ADC if another agency's negotiators are utilized.

15. At the conclusion of the incident the CNU Commander/Supervisor shall notify the ADC that the incident/deployment is over. The CNU Commander/Supervisor shall provide the ADC with the details surrounding the incident.

E. After Action Debrief: To be conducted immediately after the conclusion of an incident or training event.